Skill 14

Recognize Cognitive Biases

What Bias Is Showing?

160 Items	**1-5** Levels	**Name the thinking bias shown in a choice.** Objective

Essential question. What mental pull is shaping this judgment?

This PDF is designed for classroom use. It gives teachers a rigorous introduction to the skill, a repeatable solving routine, likely student confusions, a worked example, and the full XiXteen item set with choice-level feedback.

Generated from the current XiXteen corpus on 2026-10-29.

Skill 14

Recognize Cognitive Biases

What Bias Is Showing?

Name the thinking bias shown in a choice. Objective	**160** Items	**Levels 1-5** Difficulty bands

Essential question	What mental pull is shaping this judgment?
Why it matters	Biases are not just mistakes in arguments; they are patterns in attention, memory, confidence, and desire that shape judgment before an argument is even spoken.
Conceptual core	Cognitive biases are patterns in attention, memory, confidence, motivation, and social influence. Students should learn that bias does not mean stupidity or bad character; it means a normal mental shortcut is distorting judgment. The skill is to identify the pull: toward confirming what we already believe, following the group, protecting past effort, anchoring on the first number, or trusting what is easiest to recall.
Student method	Identify what is pulling the person's thinking off course: confirming a prior view, following the crowd, anchoring on a first number, protecting sunk costs, favoring the familiar, or overestimating certainty.
Analogy	A cognitive bias is like a lens tint. The scene is still there, but the tint changes what stands out and what fades.
Assessment focus	A good answer identifies the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking and distinguishes it from nearby labels.
Resource note	The quiz feedback links bias items to corresponding CogBias articles when a direct article match is available.

Teaching Sequence

1. Identify what the thinker is drawn toward or away from.

2. Separate evidence problems from mind-pattern problems.

3. Match the pattern to the bias label.

4. Suggest a debiasing move, such as seeking disconfirming evidence or resetting the anchor.

Common Confusions To Watch For

1. Students may label any mistake as bias without naming the mental pattern.

2. Students may confuse a fallacy in an argument with a bias in judgment.

3. Students may treat bias as something only other people have.

Teacher Prompts

1. What is pulling the person's attention?

2. What information is being overweighted or ignored?

3. What would a more balanced thinking move look like?

Worked Example

Scenario	After deciding a study app is helpful, a student reads only positive reviews and skips detailed negative reviews.
Teacher think-aloud	The student is filtering information to support a prior belief. That is confirmation bias, and the correction is to actively inspect evidence on the other side.
Student takeaway	Bias labels should point to a specific mental pull.

Guided Classroom Exercise

Invented case. Use only the facts below; write on paper. Try the steps and check your work before reading the model answer. Different wording can be equally adequate.

Situation. After buying a study app, Sam reads six glowing reviews and skips four detailed critical reviews because 'they will only make me doubt my choice'. Sam concludes the app must improve learning. No learning results have been collected.

What To Do

1. Identify the evidence Sam selects and the evidence Sam avoids, and explain the direction of the preference.

2. Write a three-step checking plan: include both kinds of reviews, use the same quality criteria for them, and collect a learning measure rather than relying only on praise.

3. Name a specific learning measure, such as a delayed quiz on comparable material, and say why review popularity alone is insufficient.

Check before reading the answer. Does your plan make it possible to discover that the purchase was unhelpful, or only reassure Sam?

Model Answer

Sam favours praise that confirms the purchase and avoids criticism that could challenge it. Plan: read all ten reviews; assess each for relevant experience and checkable evidence using the same criteria; compare delayed-quiz performance on comparable material studied with and without the app under similar conditions. Positive reviews show approval, not necessarily better learning.

Why it is adequate. It describes the selective attention and turns a vague request to 'be unbiased' into concrete checks capable of revealing a mistake.

Item Bank

Items are grouped by level. For each item, read the prompt, predict the answer, choose, and then use the feedback and process commentary to examine the reasoning path.

Level 1

Level 1 establishes the clean version of the skill: the cue is direct, the distractors are visible, and the main task is to learn the contrast.

Question 1

Level 1

In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to extend evening bus service until midnight and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: C. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 2

Level 1

In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Maya hears one vivid story about ninth-grade students and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: A. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 3

Level 1

In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: D. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 4

Level 1

In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: C. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 5

Level 1

In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Taylor predicts exact results from adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: B. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 6

Level 1

In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 7

Level 1

In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Casey praises weak evidence supporting requiring two-factor login for site administrators because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: D. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 8

Level 1

In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Jordan supports adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 9

Level 1

In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to expand peer tutoring in statistics and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: B. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 10

Level 1

In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Maya hears one vivid story about lunch customers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 11

Level 1

In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 12

Level 1

In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: C. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 13

Level 1

In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Taylor predicts exact results from offering free admission on Fridays even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: C. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 14

Level 1

In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Availability bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: D. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 15

Level 1

In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending donation receipts within one day because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: C. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 16

Level 1

In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Jordan supports offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: D. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 17

Level 1

In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to place compost bins in apartment lobbies and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: A. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 18

Level 1

In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Maya hears one vivid story about new app users and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: B. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 19

Level 1

In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Availability bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: C. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 20

Level 1

In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: A. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 21

Level 1

In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Taylor predicts exact results from launching an online apartment repair portal even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: B. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 22

Level 1

In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: D. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 23

Level 1

In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Casey praises weak evidence supporting giving support agents weekly script coaching because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: B. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 24

Level 1

In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Jordan supports sending automatic household water-leak alerts after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Anchoring	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: A. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 25

Level 1

In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: D. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 26

Level 1

In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Maya hears one vivid story about mail voters and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Availability bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: C. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 27

Level 1

In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 28

Level 1

In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: B. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 29

Level 1

In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Taylor predicts exact results from sending weekly safe-driving feedback even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: D. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 30

Level 1

In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: B. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 31

Level 1

In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Casey praises weak evidence supporting requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: D. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 32

Level 1

In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Jordan supports sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Anchoring	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: B. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Level 2

Level 2 keeps the same skill but adds more realistic wording and more tempting distractors.

Question 33

Level 2

In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Maya hears one vivid story about late-shift workers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 34

Level 2

In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: B. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 35

Level 2

In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: C. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 36

Level 2

In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Taylor predicts exact results from testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Anchoring	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: D. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 37

Level 2

In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: A. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 38

Level 2

In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Casey praises weak evidence supporting waiving late fines for children's books because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: B. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 39

Level 2

In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Jordan supports requiring two-factor login for site administrators after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: C. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 40

Level 2

In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to add brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Availability bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: D. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 41

Level 2

In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Maya hears one vivid story about first-year statistics students and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Availability bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: C. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 42

Level 2

In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: D. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 43

Level 2

In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: B. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 44

Level 2

In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Taylor predicts exact results from using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Availability bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: A. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 45

Level 2

In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: D. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 46

Level 2

In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Casey praises weak evidence supporting adding mandatory sideline concussion checks because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: C. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 47

Level 2

In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Jordan supports sending donation receipts within one day after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: B. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 48

Level 2

In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to offer monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: A. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 49

Level 2

In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Maya hears one vivid story about apartment residents and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: D. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 50

Level 2

In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Availability bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 51

Level 2

In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: B. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 52

Level 2

In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Taylor predicts exact results from boarding passengers by seat zone even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: A. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 53

Level 2

In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: C. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 54

Level 2

In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Casey praises weak evidence supporting moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: D. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 55

Level 2

In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Jordan supports giving support agents weekly script coaching after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: A. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 56

Level 2

In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send automatic household water-leak alerts and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: B. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 57

Level 2

In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Maya hears one vivid story about patrol officers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Availability bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: C. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 58

Level 2

In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: D. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 59

Level 2

In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 60

Level 2

In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Taylor predicts exact results from offering a beginner gym orientation even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: B. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 61

Level 2

In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: A. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 62

Level 2

In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Casey praises weak evidence supporting placing corrections at the top of articles because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: B. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 63

Level 2

In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Jordan supports requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: D. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 64

Level 2

In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: C. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Level 3

Level 3 asks for steadier discrimination: the right answer is still objective, but the wrong answers often sound plausible.

Question 65

Level 3

In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Availability bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: D. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 66

Level 3

In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: C. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 67

Level 3

In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Taylor predicts exact results from sending medication reminder texts before evening doses even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: B. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 68

Level 3

In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: A. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 69

Level 3

In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Casey praises weak evidence supporting adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: D. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 70

Level 3

In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Jordan supports waiving late fines for children's books after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: C. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 71

Level 3

In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to require two-factor login for site administrators and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: B. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 72

Level 3

In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Maya hears one vivid story about residents on Maple Street and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: A. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 73

Level 3

In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: D. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 74

Level 3

In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: C. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 75

Level 3

In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Taylor predicts exact results from sending overdraft warning texts before fees post even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 76

Level 3

In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: B. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 77

Level 3

In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Casey praises weak evidence supporting offering free admission on Fridays because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: C. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 78

Level 3

In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Jordan supports adding mandatory sideline concussion checks after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Availability bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: D. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 79

Level 3

In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send donation receipts within one day and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Availability bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: A. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 80

Level 3

In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Maya hears one vivid story about warehouse staff and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Availability bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: B. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 81

Level 3

In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 82

Level 3

In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Availability bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: D. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 83

Level 3

In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Taylor predicts exact results from reserving same-day appointment slots even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: C. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 84

Level 3

In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Availability bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: D. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 85

Level 3

In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Casey praises weak evidence supporting launching an online apartment repair portal because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Availability bias	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: B. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 86

Level 3

In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Jordan supports moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 87

Level 3

In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to give support agents weekly script coaching and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: D. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 88

Level 3

In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Maya hears one vivid story about local homeowners and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 89

Level 3

In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Anchoring
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: B. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 90

Level 3

In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Availability bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: A. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 91

Level 3

In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Taylor predicts exact results from sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: D. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 92

Level 3

In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: C. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 93

Level 3

In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending weekly safe-driving feedback because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: B. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 94

Level 3

In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Jordan supports placing corrections at the top of articles after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Availability bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: A. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 95

Level 3

In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to require clearer price signs at vendor stalls and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: A. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 96

Level 3

In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Maya hears one vivid story about overnight hotel guests and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: B. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Level 4

Level 4 asks learners to hold more context in mind while applying the same method.

Question 97

Level 4

In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: A. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 98

Level 4

In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Taylor predicts exact results from requiring phone lockers during class even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: B. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 99

Level 4

In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 100

Level 4

In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Casey praises weak evidence supporting testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Availability bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: D. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 101

Level 4

In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Jordan supports adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: A. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 102

Level 4

In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to waive late fines for children's books and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: B. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 103

Level 4

In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Maya hears one vivid story about site administrators and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: C. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 104

Level 4

In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: D. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 105

Level 4

In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: A. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 106

Level 4

In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Taylor predicts exact results from showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: B. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 107

Level 4

In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Availability bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: D. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 108

Level 4

In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Casey praises weak evidence supporting using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: C. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 109

Level 4

In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Jordan supports offering free admission on Fridays after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: B. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 110

Level 4

In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to add mandatory sideline concussion checks and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: A. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 111

Level 4

In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Maya hears one vivid story about first-time donors and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: D. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 112

Level 4

In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: C. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 113

Level 4

In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: B. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 114

Level 4

In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Taylor predicts exact results from making new user profiles private by default even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: A. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 115

Level 4

In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: D. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 116

Level 4

In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Casey praises weak evidence supporting boarding passengers by seat zone because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 117

Level 4

In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Jordan supports launching an online apartment repair portal after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: C. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 118

Level 4

In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to move fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Anchoring	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: D. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 119

Level 4

In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Maya hears one vivid story about support agents and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: A. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 120

Level 4

In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Anchoring
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: B. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 121

Level 4

In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: C. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 122

Level 4

In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Taylor predicts exact results from offering online mail-ballot tracking even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: D. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 123

Level 4

In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Anchoring

Answer: A. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

Question 124

Level 4

In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Casey praises weak evidence supporting offering a beginner gym orientation because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: B. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 125

Level 4

In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Jordan supports sending weekly safe-driving feedback after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Anchoring
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: A. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 126

Level 4

In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to place corrections at the top of articles and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: B. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 127

Level 4

In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Maya hears one vivid story about weekend farmers market shoppers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: D. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 128

Level 4

In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Anchoring	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: C. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Level 5

Level 5 is for fluency: the learner should now name the thinking move and explain the elimination path.

Question 129

Level 5

In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Taylor predicts exact results from extending evening bus service until midnight even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: D. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 130

Level 5

In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: C. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 131

Level 5

In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending medication reminder texts before evening doses because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Availability bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: B. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 132

Level 5

In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Jordan supports testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: A. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 133

Level 5

In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to add larger unit-price labels on shelf tags and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: D. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 134

Level 5

In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Maya hears one vivid story about families checking out children's books and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 135

Level 5

In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Availability bias	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: B. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 136

Level 5

In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: A. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 137

Level 5

In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Taylor predicts exact results from expanding peer tutoring in statistics even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: B. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 138

Level 5

In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: A. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 139

Level 5

In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending overdraft warning texts before fees post because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Status quo bias

Answer: C. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Question 140

Level 5

In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Jordan supports using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: A. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 141

Level 5

In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to offer free admission on Fridays and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Anchoring	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: A. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 142

Level 5

In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Maya hears one vivid story about youth soccer players and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: B. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 143

Level 5

In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Availability bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: A. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 144

Level 5

In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Availability bias	**B.** Anchoring
C. Sunk cost bias	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: C. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 145

Level 5

In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Taylor predicts exact results from placing compost bins in apartment lobbies even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: A. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 146

Level 5

In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Status quo bias	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: C. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 147

Level 5

In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Casey praises weak evidence supporting reserving same-day appointment slots because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: C. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 148

Level 5

In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Jordan supports boarding passengers by seat zone after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: D. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 149

Level 5

In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to launch an online apartment repair portal and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Availability bias	**D.** Confirmation bias

Answer: D. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

Question 150

Level 5

In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Maya hears one vivid story about middle-school students and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Availability bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 151

Level 5

In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Anchoring
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: B. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 152

Level 5

In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Motivated reasoning	**D.** Bandwagon effect

Answer: A. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Question 153

Level 5

In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Taylor predicts exact results from sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Anchoring
C. Availability bias	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: D. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 154

Level 5

In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Status quo bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: B. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 155

Level 5

In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Status quo bias	**B.** Overconfidence bias
C. Bandwagon effect	**D.** Motivated reasoning

Answer: D. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D. Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

Question 156

Level 5

In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Jordan supports offering a beginner gym orientation after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning	**B.** Bandwagon effect
C. Overconfidence bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: B. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B. Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Question 157

Level 5

In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send weekly safe-driving feedback and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect	**B.** Confirmation bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: B. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B. Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 158

Level 5

In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Maya hears one vivid story about newsletter readers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias	**B.** Sunk cost bias
C. Confirmation bias	**D.** Availability bias

Answer: D. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C. Not correct. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D. Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

Question 159

Level 5

In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias	**B.** Availability bias
C. Anchoring	**D.** Overconfidence bias

Answer: C. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C. Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D. Not correct. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

Question 160

Level 5

In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Anchoring	**B.** Motivated reasoning
C. Availability bias	**D.** Sunk cost bias

Answer: D. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

How to work it out. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

A. Not correct. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B. Not correct. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C. Not correct. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D. Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect